

Title: *A Spelman Christmas*

"Because sometimes the only thing more complicated than family... is coming home to them."

TREATMENT

This story is personal. It's about an african-american woman's legacy, and the beautiful, messy dance we do when we come home to each other, especially around the holidays.

Dr. Geneva Ellis is *that* Spelman woman: polished, brilliant, beloved by her students but behind the strong exterior, she's a widow trying to survive her first Christmas without the love of her life. Her plan? Cancel Christmas. No lights, no music, no fuss. Just silence.

But God had other plans.

Her three daughters, Zora, Simone, and Imani, decide to come home for the holidays. None of them asked permission, of course. And none of them know how to mind their business. Each one walks through the front door carrying her own kind of chaos: career burnout, surprise fiancé (who's white, bless him), and a secret baby bump. Yeah... Geneva's house is about to get real crowded.

And what starts off as a Christmas disaster slowly turns into something beautiful.

It's a story about what happens when the daughters return to the mother. About how grief and healing can live in the same room. And how laughter, love, and the smell of sweet potato pie can break down walls that years of silence built up.

It's Atlanta. It's Spelman. It's us.

OUTLINE:

Act I – Home Is Where the Chaos Is

- Geneva's plan to skip Christmas is foiled when her girls come home unannounced.
- Zora wants to quit her fancy D.C. job. Simone brings a man nobody was expecting. Imani's pregnant and terrified.
- Geneva is unimpressed and emotionally unavailable. Her house, her rules.

Act II – Holiday Heat & Sister Drama

- The Ellis women fall into old patterns: Zora's the perfectionist, Simone's the rebel, Imani's overlooked.
- Tension peaks at dinner when all the secrets come out. Geneva is hurt. The girls feel judged.
- But a candlelight Christmas celebration on Spelman's campus starts to soften things.

Act III – The Gift of Showing Up

- The family begins to reconnect. Geneva opens up about her grief. The daughters comfort her.
- They cook their father's gumbo together. They laugh, cry, and finally see each other.
- Christmas morning is quiet but full of love. They're not perfect but they're together.

What It's About, Really:

It's about Black women who carry so much but forget they don't have to carry it alone.

It's about mothers and daughters finding each other again.

And it's about how sometimes... Christmas gives us the pause we need to finally feel.